[LIT-FLK-014] Kasomwoshi Kala Khaying-Sha

Translation: Kasomwoshi and the Spirit Beast of the Deep Forest

Work Type: FOLK_TALE | Creator: Kasom & Somra Village Elders | Year: 1982
Village: Kasom | Dialect: Southern Tangkhul / Standard Tangkhul | Book ID: BK-CIIL-003
Publisher / Source: Central Institute of Indian Languages / Tangkhul F
Clearance: Traditional Oral Heritage | Permission: community_authorized | Status: verified

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Themes: Sacred mountain hunting taboos and forest conservation (*Khaying Ngashitpam*), Encounter with the primordial forest spirit beast (*Khaying-

Structure & Meter: Epic oral narrative composed in traditional heptametric verse with did

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Critical Overview: A foundational environmental folktale from the southern Tangkhul and Somra borderlands. It embodies indigenous environmental

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Indigenous Tangkhul Literary Text / Stanzas:

Somra phungkhuili kapam thikashung mayarnao Kasomwoshi, ngaleiwui changv
Chitharan khaying ngashitpamli zatta mayarnao, ngalei mashun kahao ngash
Khaying-Shawui mikron kazing mei thada tontata, kaphung matha kachiphunl
’I-ramwui sha kala thingwon mashukalu!’ da, kaphung ngalei katharao wui
Kasomwoshina changvei eina malen thada kakhayei kachon horkhui-laga, kap
Khamashung shatung kazat mayarnao hi ningkacham eina phung-ngathangli ma

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English Translation & Literary Rendering:

In the rugged mountain ridges of Somra lived the renowned master hunter
Venture he did into the primeval sanctuary of the sacred forest, where t
With eyes glowing like celestial embers, the spirit beast roared across
’Do not pillage the wild creatures nor strip bare the fragrant flowering
Kasomwoshi lowered his iron lance and customary quiver, bowing in revere
The righteous hunter understood that mountain stewardship requires restr

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Key Poetic & Literary Vocabulary Terms:

* Khaying-Sha : Primordial spirit beast / mythological guardian of
* Changvei : Customary Tangkhul warrior lance adorned with dyed
* Malen : Customary hunting quiver crafted from cured bamboo